

PRIVATE · VERSION 1.0 · JULY 2026

Family Money HQ

The blueprint for Shlomo & Rachel's money operating system:
every account in one place, spending with guardrails,
savings on autopilot, and a plan for real estate and the kids.

"I want to take any money that I get and do it right.
I want to spend right. I want it to keep me in check."

This document is the whole plan. We perfect this first —
then we build it exactly as written.

SECTION 1

Vision — what this app is

One private website where Shlomo and Rachel each sign in and see the family's entire financial life — every bank account, every credit card, every property, every goal — with a system that makes the right thing automatic and the wrong thing hard.

The app has **three jobs**, in priority order:

- **Keep us in check.** Watch every transaction, compare it to our plan, and speak up — kindly but immediately — when spending drifts. Built for a person who knows he has a compulsive relationship with spending and wants structure, not shame.
- **Make saving and investing automatic.** Money that arrives gets routed by rules we set in calm moments — to savings, investments, and real-estate fund — before it can be spent in impulsive ones.
- **Teach us as we go.** The best books and thinkers, built into the app as a curriculum, plus an AI coach that answers questions using *our* real numbers and *our* rulebook.

What success looks like after 12 months: every account connected and reconciled weekly; zero months where fixed costs exceed 60% of take-home; a funded 6-month emergency reserve; automatic monthly investing that never got skipped; the estate/trust checklist finished; and at most one real-estate purchase — made calmly, on our numbers, inside our allocation cap.

SECTION 2

Who signs in, and what they see

Person	Role	What they see & do
Shlomo	Owner	Everything. Sets rules with Rachel. Receives guardrail alerts about his own spending. Cannot silently raise his own limits — changes take effect after a 72-hour delay and a note to Rachel (self-binding by design).
Rachel	Owner	Everything, equal standing. Receives the weekly digest and any tripped guardrail alerts. Approves rule changes early (the two-key rule).
Kids (later)	Viewer	Optional future: age-appropriate view of their own 529 growth and a savings match — money education, no account access.
Advisor / CPA (later)	Guest	Read-only, time-limited link to reports for the annual review. No credentials, no transaction detail unless we share it.

Sign-in: email + password + two-factor (authenticator app or passkey). Sessions expire. Every sensitive action (rule change, transfer rule, export) is logged in an audit trail both of us can read — trust through transparency, the same principle as the Armada audit log.

SECTION 3

The eight pillars

Everything the app does falls under one of these. If a feature idea doesn't fit a pillar, it doesn't go in v1.

1. Connected accounts

Every bank account, credit card, loan, and investment account linked through a bank-data provider (Plaid — see Section 6). Balances and transactions sync automatically several times a day. Manual accounts (cash, a private loan, the business draw) can be added by hand. One screen = the whole picture.

2. The Spending Plan engine

The four buckets from the current mini-app (fixed / investments / savings / guilt-free), now fed by real transactions. Every transaction is auto-categorized into a bucket; each week the app shows bucket-by-bucket actual vs. plan. Guilt-free money is truly guilt-free — the app celebrates it, not just tolerates it.

3. Guardrails — “keep me in check”

The conscience of the app. Real-time rules that watch spending velocity and unusual activity and respond on a ladder: nudge > alert > cool-down > tell Rachel. Full design in Section 4.

4. Autopilot savings & transfers

Rules like “1st of month: move \$X to savings” or “any deposit over \$Y: route 20% to the real-estate fund.” Starts as guided transfers (the app tells us, one tap to approve), graduates to true automatic transfers once trust is earned. Design and safety rails in Section 5.

5. Net worth & goals

The monthly scoreboard: assets minus debts, trend over time, progress bars for each named goal (emergency fund, next property, simchas, the kids). This is the page we open at the monthly money meeting.

6. Real-estate desk

Allocation cap (target % of net worth), a deal analyzer that forces day-one cash-flow math on every prospective property, and a pipeline board (watching > analyzed > offer > owned). Section 7.

7. The Library & curriculum

The eight books and their authors as a guided reading plan with notes we keep, plus short in-app lessons distilled from each (the same course engine idea as Armada's Training). Includes a dedicated track on compulsive spending and money psychology.

8. The AI coach

Ask anything in plain English — “can we afford the Pesach trip?”, “how did we do this month?”, “is this duplex a good deal?” — and Claude answers grounded in our live numbers, our rulebook, and the Library's principles. It coaches in a warm, direct voice; it never scolds.

SECTION 4

The guardrail engine — designed for a compulsive spender

This is the heart of the app and the reason it exists. It is built on how compulsive spending actually works: the urge is short, the regret is long, and willpower at the moment of purchase is the wrong tool. So the app adds time, friction, and witness — the three things that beat impulse.

The alert ladder

Level	Trigger (draft examples)	What happens
Nudge	A guilt-free bucket reaches 70% with a week left in the month.	Quiet in-app note. No shame, just information: “\$430 left in fun money — 9 days to go.”
Alert	Single purchase over the agreed threshold (e.g. \$500), or a bucket goes over 100%.	Push notification to Shlomo within minutes of the transaction posting, with a one-line “here's what this does to the month.”
Cool-down	Three alerts in a week, or spending velocity 2× normal for 3 days running.	The app proposes the 24-hour rule: a want-to-buy list where items must sit 24h (over \$200) or 7 days (over \$1,000) before purchase. Tracks how many listed items we still wanted after the wait — usually few.
Witness	Cool-down ignored, or a single transaction over the two-key threshold (e.g. \$2,500).	Rachel gets notified — automatically, as agreed in advance, so it's the system telling her, not Shlomo confessing. Big purchases simply require both of us. That's the two-key rule.

Design principles for the compulsive-spending features

- **Self-binding, set in calm moments.** All limits are set (and can only be loosened) with a 72-hour delay and Rachel's visibility. Tightening is instant. Ulysses tied himself to the mast *before* he heard the sirens.
- **Friction for wants, none for needs.** Fixed costs and groceries flow untouched. Friction concentrates only where impulse lives.
- **No shame mechanics.** No red screens of failure, no streak-breaking guilt. The tone is a good sponsor's tone: honest, warm, next-step focused. A blown week gets a reset button and one

question: “what triggered it?”

- **An urge journal.** One tap logs “I wanted to buy ____ because ____.” Over months this becomes the trigger map — the same pulse-and-pattern idea as Armada’s AMA early-warning system, pointed at spending.
- **The replacement, not just the restraint.** Every blocked impulse shows the goal it feeds instead: “that \$1,800 is 1.2% of the next property.” Compulsion responds better to a bigger yes than a louder no.
- **Beyond the app — named honestly.** Compulsive spending can be a real behavioral addiction. The app links to Debtors Anonymous (spender-focused meetings), and to finding a therapist who works with money behaviors. Shlomo runs a recovery organization; this app treats his own recovery lane with the same respect. Software is a tool here, not the treatment.

SECTION 5

Autopilot — how money actually moves

Honest engineering truth: a website cannot and should not just reach into bank accounts and move money on day one. We earn our way to automation in three stages, each fully useful on its own.

Stage	How transfers work	Trust required
A. Guided	The app computes the routing the moment income lands — “move \$4,000: \$2,500 savings, \$1,500 brokerage” — and sends a push notification. One tap opens the bank app; we mark it done. The app verifies it actually happened via the transaction feed.	None — we execute, app verifies.
B. Bank-native rules	We set the recurring transfers up inside the banks themselves (every bank supports scheduled transfers), and the app becomes the auditor: it knows the rules and confirms each one ran, alerting if one fails or gets quietly cancelled.	Low — banks move the money; app watches.
C. App-initiated	The app moves money itself via Plaid Transfer / ACH. Only between our own accounts, only under per-transfer and monthly caps, only per rules approved by both of us, with instant reversibility notices.	High — added in Phase 3 only if Stages A–B feel limiting.

Bank connections (read side)

We use **Plaid** (or an equivalent aggregator like MX/Finicity) for account linking. What matters to know: we log into each bank through Plaid’s own secure window — **our app never sees or stores bank passwords**. Plaid hands the app read-only tokens for balances and transactions. This is the same rails used by Venmo, Chime, and every budgeting app. Costs roughly \$0.30–\$1.50 per connected account per month at our scale — trivial.

Income detection: the app recognizes deposits (salary, distributions, rent) and fires the routing rules from Stage A/B/C the same day. That is the mechanical answer to “take any money I get and do it right”: the decision was made once, in advance, together.

SECTION 6

The Rulebook — the numbers the app enforces

These are the “insane guidelines” — written once, enforced by software. Draft values below; we finalize them together before build. The app ships with these as defaults and every one is tunable (with the 72-hour loosening delay).

#	Rule	Draft value
R1	Fixed costs ceiling (% of take-home)	60% max
R2	Automatic investing floor (% of take-home, monthly)	15% min
R3	Guilt-free spending — protected, not just capped	20–30%
R4	Emergency reserve target (months of expenses, high-yield savings)	6 months
R5	Real-estate allocation cap (% of net worth incl. home)	40% max
R6	Single-purchase alert threshold	\$500
R7	24-hour rule threshold / 7-day rule threshold	\$200 / \$1,000
R8	Two-key purchases (both must approve)	\$2,500+
R9	Any new debt besides a mortgage	Two-key + 7 days
R10	Weekly money check-in (15 min) / monthly meeting (45 min)	Sun / 1st of month
R11	Rental deals must cash-flow day one (after vacancy, mgmt, upkeep)	DSCR 1.25+
R12	Tzedakah / giving — planned like a bucket, not an afterthought	set together

The rulebook lives on its own page in the app, signed by both of us, with a change history. Rules are the product; screens are just how we look at them.

SECTION 7

The real-estate desk

Real estate is a lane, not the whole road. The desk keeps it disciplined.

- **Allocation gauge.** Live view of real estate as % of net worth against the R5 cap — the same calculator as the mini-app, now fed by real balances. When we're at cap, the desk says so on

every deal screen.

- **Deal analyzer.** Enter address, price, expected rent > the app forces the boring math: vacancy 8%, management 8–10%, maintenance/capex 10–15%, taxes, insurance, real mortgage quote. Outputs cash-on-cash return, cap rate, DSCR, and a plain verdict. *No deal can be marked “buy” if it fails R11.*
- **Pipeline board.** Watching > Analyzed > Offer > Owned. Every property we even glance at gets a card, so urgency-sellers can be answered with data.
- **Owned-property P&L.** Each property’s rent, expenses, equity, and true annual return — compared honestly against “what if this equity were in index funds instead.”
- **The funding path.** A named goal (“Property #1 fund”) that the autopilot feeds monthly. The desk shows time-to-down-payment at current pace.

SECTION 8

Architecture & stack

Deliberately boring technology, matched to what already runs Armada — so one person can maintain it.

Layer	Choice	Why
Frontend	Server-rendered pages + light JS (same pattern as Armada), installable as a phone app (PWA) for push notifications.	Fast to build, easy to change, works on both phones.
Backend	Node.js + Express	Same stack as Armada — shared skills, shared patterns.
Database	PostgreSQL (encrypted at rest)	Real relational data: accounts, transactions, rules, audit log.
Bank data	Plaid (Transactions + Auth; Transfer in Phase 3)	Industry standard; no credentials touch our server.
AI	Claude API (claude-sonnet-5 for the coach; Haiku for auto-categorization)	Coach answers grounded in our data + Rulebook; cheap fast model for the transaction stream.
Notifications	Web push + SMS fallback (Twilio) for Witness-level alerts.	Guardrails only work if they reach the phone in minutes.
Hosting	Render (same as Armada) — separate account/project from the business.	One-click deploys; personal data stays fully out of the company’s systems.

Running cost estimate

Hosting + database ~ \$25–40/mo · Plaid ~ \$10–30/mo (10–20 accounts) · Claude API ~ \$5–20/mo at personal volume · Twilio ~ \$5/mo. **Total ~ \$50–100/month.** Cheaper than one impulse purchase it prevents.

SECTION 9

Security & privacy — non-negotiables

- **This is not part of the Armada app.** Separate codebase, separate database, separate hosting account. No employee, ever, has access.
- **No bank credentials on our server.** Bank logins happen inside Plaid's window; we store only revocable tokens.
- **Two-factor for both users; passkeys preferred.** Password resets require the second factor.
- **Encryption** in transit (TLS) and at rest (database + backups). Nightly encrypted backups with a tested restore.
- **Full audit log** of every login, rule change, and export — readable by both of us, deletable by neither.
- **Kill switch.** One button revokes all Plaid tokens and freezes transfers instantly, from either phone.
- **The AI coach sees numbers, not credentials,** and its conversations stay in our database.

SECTION 10

What this app will not do

Written down so the blueprint stays honest.

- It will not **replace the professionals**: the estate attorney does the trust; a fee-only fiduciary reviews the big picture annually; a therapist or DA meeting addresses compulsion at the root. The app tracks that these happen — it doesn't pretend to be them.
- It will not **move money it wasn't told to move**, ever, and app-initiated transfers arrive only in Phase 3, capped and two-key approved.
- It will not **pick investments or time markets**. The investing rule is a boring automatic index-fund transfer; the app's job is to make sure it fires.
- It will not **police Rachel**, or become a surveillance tool in either direction. Guardrails apply to the plan, alerts are symmetric, and every monitoring feature is one both partners agreed to in writing (this document).
- It will not **hold this data hostage** — full export (CSV/JSON) any time.

SECTION 11

Build phases

Each phase is a complete, useful product. We use each one for real before building the next — the app earns its next power by being right with the current one.

Phase	What ships	We know it works when...
1 — The Cockpit (~2–3 wks)	Logins for two + 2FA · manual accounts & CSV import · four-bucket plan vs. actual · net worth & goals · Rulebook page · Library · weekly digest email.	We run one full monthly money meeting entirely inside the app.
2 — Live Data (~3–4 wks)	Plaid linking for all accounts · auto-categorization (Claude) · real-time guardrail ladder with push alerts · urge journal & want-to-buy list · income detection with guided routing (Stage A).	An over-threshold purchase pings Shlomo's phone within minutes; a month of transactions needs under 15 minutes of manual fixing.
3 — Autopilot (~3–4 wks)	Bank-rule auditor (Stage B) · then app-initiated transfers (Stage C) with caps + two-key · AI coach over live data · cool-down & witness automation.	Three consecutive months where saving/investing happened with zero manual steps and zero missed rules.
4 — The Desk (~2–3 wks)	Real-estate deal analyzer, pipeline, owned-property P&L · annual report pack for the advisor/CPA · kids' view.	First property analyzed — or rightly rejected — inside the app.

SECTION 12

Decisions to make before we build

The blueprint is finished when every line below has an answer. This is the agenda for one sit-down between Shlomo and Rachel.

#	Decision	Notes
D1	Final Rulebook numbers (R1–R12)	Section 6 has drafts
D2	The list of accounts & cards to connect	banks, cards, loans, brokerage
D3	Alert thresholds & quiet hours	e.g. no pings on Shabbos — define the window
D4	Witness-level wording	exactly what Rachel's alert says — dignity matters
D5	Money dials	the 1–2 categories we spend lavishly on, guilt-free
D6	Auto-transfer amounts & dates	and which stage (A/B/C) we start at
D7	Estate checklist owner & deadline	who books the attorney, by when
D8	Outside support	therapist / DA meeting cadence — named, scheduled
D9	App name & domain	Family Money HQ is a placeholder

#	Decision	Notes
D10	What the kids see, and when	Phase 4

Next step: read this together at the first weekly check-in. Mark up anything wrong or missing — especially Sections 4 and 6 — and the blueprint gets revised until it's exactly right. Then Phase 1 starts.

Family Money HQ · Blueprint v1.0 · Prepared July 2026 · Education and planning document — not legal, tax, or investment advice.